COST Intelligence Report

Report as_of: **2026-10-26** | Market data as_of: **2026-10-26** | Market fetched: **2026-10-27 02:00 UTC**

Costco Wholesale Corporation | Consumer Defensive / Discount Stores

AI status: **Available** | Configured model: **openai/gpt-oss-20b** | News snapshot: **2026-10-26**

Classification review flags: **1** (automated anomaly checks, not established errors; see flagged articles below).

Previously reviewed headlines reused from integrity-verified archive: **6**; archived source date **2026-10-25**. Reused classifications are not fresh model calls.

Report rendering uses saved source snapshots with separate observation dates. The daily price bar may be provisional before the listing market closes. Check source dates and availability.

Publication-age audit (relative to report date): 15 in the current event window; 1 presented as historical context; 0 missing publication dates. Recent publication does not verify the underlying claim.

News (report-date window: previous 7 days plus report date): **23** unique headlines; **23** classified or explicitly excluded; **0** still unclassified. Named publishers: **9**. Latest RSS publication: **2026-10-26**.

Quantitative

Metric	Value
Close	1005.1600
Return 1D (%)	0.1834
Return 1W (%)	0.9673
Return 1M (%)	8.9285
Return YTD (%)	17.0764
Return 1Y (%)	8.4627
Annualized volatility (%)	19.8076
Beta vs SPY	-0.1779
Max drawdown (%)	-18.1993
Sharpe (rf=0)	0.5247
Downside deviation (rf=0, %)	13.7097
Sortino (rf=0)	0.7581
Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)	2.0804
Historical ES 95% (1D, %)	2.7374
Correlation vs SPY	-0.1142
Tracking error vs SPY (%)	24.7301
P/E (trailing)	48.42
P/B	12.44
EV/EBITDA	30.62
Revenue growth (%)	11.10
Forward P/E (estimate)	40.16
Gross margin (%)	12.77

Metric	Value
Operating margin (%)	3.79
Return on equity (%)	28.40
Free cash flow yield (%)	1.52
MA50	939.7460
Close vs MA50 (%)	6.9608
MA200	968.1091
Close vs MA200 (%)	3.8271
RSI (14, Wilder)	69.6847
MACD (12,26)	22.3193
MACD signal (9)	17.3044
MACD histogram	5.0149

Methodology: adjusted daily closes (yfinance auto_adjust=True; Stooq fallback if unavailable). 1Y return uses the last trading day on or before the one-year boundary. Risk metrics use historical returns and are not forecasts; asset and SPY returns are not FX-adjusted in cross-listing comparisons. Free cash flow yield is unavailable unless vendor financial and listing currencies match. See unavailable values as N/A.

HOW TO READ THE QUANTITATIVE SECTION

These rule-based bands are judgment choices for this research report, not investment advice.

The table above contains the complete metric set. This compact guide highlights ten research-context measures; definitions and full interpretation are retained in the accompanying Markdown and data snapshots.

- **Return 1D (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one trading day is measured as a percentage. Observed: 0.1834. Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Return 1Y (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one year is measured as a percentage. Observed: 8.4627. Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Annualized volatility (%)**: The variability of daily returns is scaled to one year as a percentage. Observed: 19.8076. Low annualized volatility.
- **Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)**: Observed daily loss at the empirical fifth-percentile return, floored at zero; not a maximum loss. Observed: 2.0804.
- **Historical ES 95% (1D, %)**: Average observed loss in returns at or below the empirical fifth percentile, floored at zero. Observed: 2.7374.
- **Beta vs SPY**: Beta estimates how sensitively returns move with the SPY market benchmark. Observed: -0.1779. Inverse market sensitivity.
- **Max drawdown (%)**: The largest peak-to-trough price decline in the sampled history is measured as a percentage. Observed: -18.1993. Moderate peak-to-trough loss magnitude.
- **Sharpe (rf=0)**: Sharpe measures annualized return per unit of volatility using a zero risk-free rate. Observed: 0.5247. Modest risk-adjusted return.
- **P/E (trailing)**: The share price is divided by trailing earnings per share. Observed: 48.4181. High trailing earnings multiple under the research bands.
- **RSI (14, Wilder)**: The 14-period relative strength index compares recent gains with losses on a 0 to 100 scale. Observed: 69.6847. Neutral momentum reading.

Tailwinds

1. How AI Product Expansion At Costco (COST) Has Changed Its Investment Story

AI product expansion enhances Costco’s value proposition, potentially boosting future earnings.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **medium** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: Simply Wall Street

Headwinds

No qualified events assigned to this category among 23 sampled headlines; this does not prove no events occurred.

Catalysts

1. Costco's Last Stock Split Was in 2000. Is Its Board Close to Another?

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

2. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Shares Sold by Guardian Investment Management

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

3. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Shares Bought by Simplicity Wealth LLC

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

4. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock: WASHINGTON TRUST Co Increases Position

Date: **2026-10-25** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

5. What Could Surprise Costco Stock Investors On The Upside?

Speculation on potential positive surprises for Costco investors.

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.6**

Review suggested: low_uncalibrated_model_confidence (not a confirmed classification error).

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: Trefis

6. Costco (COST) Stock Looks Expensive Despite Strong Sales Growth

Analysts note high valuation amid sales growth, suggesting caution for investors.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 7 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

7. Is Trending Stock Costco Wholesale Corporation (COST) a Buy Now?

Opinion piece questioning if Costco is a good buy at current price.

Date: **2026-10-20** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 6 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

8. Is Costco (COST) a Buy as Wall Street Analysts Look Optimistic?

Analysts express optimism, recommending a buy for Costco shares.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 3 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

9. Costco (COST) Advances While Market Declines: Some Information for Investors

Costco shares rise despite broader market downturn, indicating resilience.

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 4 days before report date (historical context; not a new market-moving event).

Sources: Yahoo Finance

10. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock: Sterling Capital Management LLC Decreases Stake

Sterling Capital reduces its stake in Costco, potentially signaling a shift in investor confidence.

Date: **2026-10-25** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

11. 38 ETFs Add to Costco (COST) Holdings on Thursday

ETFs increased holdings in Costco, indicating broader institutional interest.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: GuruFocus

12. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Shares Newly Purchased by Norris Perne & French LLP MI

Shares of Costco purchased by Norris Perne & French LLP MI.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

13. Costco (COST) director Decker holds 8,798 shares directly after receiving a 266-unit stock grant.

Director Decker now directly owns 8,798 shares following a 266-unit stock grant, indicating increased insider ownership.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: Stock Titan

14. Costco (Nasdaq: COST) withholds 537 shares for taxes as its accounting chief receives a stock grant.

Accounting chief receives a stock grant; 537 shares withheld for taxes, reflecting a new insider ownership stake.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: Stock Titan

15. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Holdings Increased by Orange Investment Advisors Inc.

Orange Investment Advisors Inc. increased its holdings in Costco, signaling a larger institutional stake.

Date: **2026-10-26** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

Risks

No qualified events assigned to this category among 23 sampled headlines; this does not prove no events occurred.

Peer Comparables

Ticker	P/E	P/B	EV/EBITDA	Rev growth (%)	Mkt cap (local)	1Y ret (%)
COST	**48.42**	**12.44**	**30.62**	**11.10**	**445.42B USD**	**8.46**
WMT	43.58	9.73	23.25	5.90	957.28B USD	14.25
TGT	15.42	3.78	9.46	5.30	67.48B USD	63.96
BJ	23.27	6.12	13.94	15.70	13.43B USD	15.90

Peers fetched as_of: 2026-10-26; COST reuses existing data. Fundamentals are yfinance info snapshots; missing values are not interpolated.

Earnings Calendar

Last reported earnings: **2026-09-24**
Next expected earnings: **2026-12-10** (yfinance; expected dates may change)

Macro (FRED)

Metric	Series	Latest value	Obs. date
Unemployment rate (%)	UNRATE	4.200	2026-09-01
Consumer Price Index (1982–1984=100)	CPIAUCSL	336.298	2026-09-01
Federal funds rate (%)	FEDFUNDS	3.750	2026-09-01
ISM Manufacturing PMI	NAPM	N/A	N/A

Fetched as_of: 2026-10-26

Latest Filing (EDGAR)

Form: **10-K** | Filing date: **2026-10-07**
Revenue (latest quarter): 69,597,000,000.00 USD; period 2025-11-24/2026-02-15; fiscal 2026/Q2
Net income (latest quarter): 2,192,000,000.00 USD; period 2026-02-16/2026-05-10; fiscal 2026/Q3
SEC filing: Open on SEC EDGAR

SEC requests use the configured organization and contact identity. Financial values use directly reported periods of approximately three months, without deriving quarters from cumulative values.

Sources

- [1] Simply Wall Street (news.google.com)
- [2] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [3] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [4] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [5] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [6] Trefis (news.google.com)
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- [12] GuruFocus (news.google.com)
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- [14] Stock Titan (news.google.com)
- [15] Stock Titan (news.google.com)
- [16] MarketBeat (news.google.com)

API documentation: SEC EDGAR APIs | FRED observations

Research notes and limitations

Daily multi-source research; AI items require human spot checks; RSS coverage is not guaranteed. Missing market data or fundamentals are marked N/A; no numbers are fabricated.

This report is not investment advice.